

FlyRank Channel Expansion

Finding niche channels FlyRank isn't using yet — ranked shortlist & test plan

1. Ideal Customer Profile (verified)

FlyRank's ideal customer is a CEO or senior marketing decision-maker at a funded, revenue-generating DTC/ecommerce brand, who is struggling to reach target customers organically and is losing visibility in search rankings and AI citations.

Evidence: named case studies (BattlBox, Cymbiotika, Praella) feature founder-level testimonials; pricing starts at \$1,499/mo, ruling out small bootstrapped stores; marketing language centers on moving from "invisible" to "discovered" and growing AI-citation visibility.

Caveat: FlyRank's site also claims B2B SaaS and Agencies as target segments — treated here as secondary/aspirational, since public proof (named case studies) for those segments is currently thin.

2. Current Channel Mix (verified)

FlyRank's actual channel mix is broader than the brief's starting list of Meta ads, cold email, and LinkedIn suggested:

- LinkedIn — 64K followers, active but inconsistent posting; mixes case-study/solutions content with internship recruiting.
- Cold email — funnels to a "Book a Call" CTA on the website.
- YouTube (previously unlisted) — 13.4K subscribers, 40 videos, 174K views, but 100% of content is internship-focused; none targets the actual ICP.
- Meta ads — claimed per the brief, but no active ads were found live during verification (Meta Ad Library search).
- Twitter/X — effectively dormant: 674 followers, 7 posts, inactive since March 2026.

3. Ranked Shortlist — Channels to Test Next Month

Each candidate below was verified as real and active before inclusion. Ranked by fit to the ICP, cost/effort, and strength of signal from a small test.

#	Channel	Effort / Cost	One-line test plan
1	GEO Slack community (Gen Engine Optimizers / #llm-visibility, Grow Your Agency Slack)	Low effort · Free	Post one genuinely useful AI-citation breakdown in #llm-visibility, no pitch — track replies/DMs.
2	r/ecommerce & r/shopify	Low-med effort · Free	Publish one data-backed case-study post (e.g. "page 4 to page 1") — track upvotes/comments/DMs.
3	Sponsor a slot at "Ecom Network" founder mixers (Eventbrite, NYC/Toronto/Vancouver)	Low-med effort · Modest sponsor fee	Sponsor one upcoming mixer, get branded mention, track founder conversations generated.
4	FlyRank-owned Medium publication (GEO/AEO)	Low effort · \$50/yr	Publish 1-2 repurposed articles under a new publication — track views/claps/follows over 2-3 weeks.
5	Reposition existing YouTube channel (13.4K subs, currently 100% internship content)	Medium effort · Low-med cost (time only)	Publish one short case-study/explainer video, compare engagement vs. internship videos.

4. Rationale, Bet-First Order

#1 — GEO Slack Community (bet first)

A room of marketers and agency owners already discussing the exact problem FlyRank solves (AI citations/visibility). Free, fast to test, and replies/DMs are a high-quality signal — a real qualified conversation, not a vanity metric.

#2 — r/ecommerce / r/shopify

Large (250k+), active, precisely-matched audience. Free to test; Reddit rewards genuine value posts with measurable engagement. Ranked below #1 only because Reddit audiences are more anonymous and harder to convert than a smaller, closer-knit Slack.

#3 — Sponsor a slot at "Ecom Network" founder mixers

Best in-person fit, with real precedent — a competing tool already sponsored drinks + a mention at one event. Ranked third due to higher friction: requires physical presence or shipping, and city coverage (NYC/Toronto/Vancouver) is limited.

#4 — FlyRank-owned Medium Publication

Cheap (\$50/year), near-zero existing competition in the GEO/AEO niche, and strategically aligned (AI engines frequently cite Medium content). Ranked lower because demand is unproven — this is a "plant an early flag" bet, not a guaranteed quick win.

#5 — Reposition Existing YouTube Channel

A real, owned-asset opportunity — the channel already has 13.4K subscribers but is 100% internship-focused. Ranked last only because it carries the highest production effort (scripting, filming, editing) of the five for a test meant to be small and cheap.

5. Considered and Dropped

Documented for completeness — each was evaluated against the ICP and cut for a specific, evidence-based reason:

- GitHub — wrong audience (developers, not marketing/founder decision-makers).
- Local newspapers (FT/Economic Times) — too broad and expensive; not a niche, cheap test.
- In-person meetups (generic) — real but high-effort/local, harder to test cheaply than the shortlisted options.
- Indie Hackers — active-ish but declining, and its core audience (solo, bootstrapped software founders) doesn't match FlyRank's funded DTC/ecommerce ICP.
- MBA/university tie-ups — genuine synergy with FlyRank's existing internship program, but current students aren't the ICP; reaching founder-alumni specifically would need a longer partnership-building effort than a cheap test.